

C1: Introductory course



Universitatea
Transilvania
din Braşov

FACULTATEA DE SOCIOLOGIE
ŞI COMUNICARE



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General description:

Specialized discipline

Number of credits: 5

(2 hours course + 2 hours seminar) x 14 weeks

Self-study hours: 69/ (study according to course material, readings and notes, seminar work, homework and projects)



Course description. It's about...

- communication process in social networks, trends in social media
- Sociability and socialisation
- identity and interaction in social media (SM) [individualisation vs. de-individualisation].
- digital culture - participatory culture
- Media globalisation and social change [implications of SM]
- how we (objectively) research and analyse SM [critical thinking]
- Listening and tracking SM content



It is NOT about ...

- how to manage your accounts or optimise your profile on the various SM platforms
- how you can attract more people to follow you
- how to conduct SM marketing

OBJECTIVES

- ❑ **Knowledge and understanding of concepts, theories, paradigms and models used in the analysis of social media communication**
 - **Define and understand concepts, theories, paradigms and methods of communication sciences to understand the development and use of SM.**
 - **Handling communication from the perspective of specific social media parameters.**
 - **Identify the impact of SM on the public sphere and specific social phenomena;**
 - **Understand the role of SM in developing organisations and in relationships and interactions between individuals.**

Competences acquired

- ❑ To identify and use the language and expertise in communication sciences to understand the use and operation of SM (the content creation and tracking) by means of class discussions, seminar activities and the final project.
- ❑ To understand the various methodological approaches that can be used in the study of SM - by course discussions, seminar applications and through course work and discussion of the required and recommended bibliography.
- ❑ To understand the psychosocial effects of SM by following the course and the compulsory bibliography and through class discussion.
- ❑ To be able to discuss SM and its role at a personal and organisational level using expert language and critical thinking.

TOPICS

What is Social Media? Impact in the social sciences; Conditions for development. History of Social Media vs. New Media. Social Media vs. Social Networking

Sociability, social capital and social ties. Social networks (types of networks, theories of network ties, indicators for measuring cohesion and density in a network, network information distribution)

Digitization of culture. Participatory culture. Spreadable media.

Virtual communities. The need for affiliation and building online groups. Identity in the online environment. Psychosocial implications.

Research about SM. Socio-cultural particularities and implications on different SM platforms.

Implications of Big Data and AI in SM.

Social Media



Facebook



TikTok



Inst



ASSESSMENT and ... expectations

- Course activity 15%
- Seminar activity 20%
- Exam (written or grid test) 45%
- Research project 20%



Social media:

- ❑ The term is frequently used in everyday conversations and by journalists.



Social media:

❑ overuse of the term

❑ controversies



În mod avion



Legături primejdioase



Assassination Nation



My Fake Boyfriend



Your Excellency



Disclosure



Dilema socială



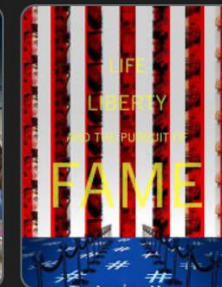
The Great Hack:
Iluzia intimității



Childhood 2.0



Screenagers



Mema americană:
Viața, libertatea ...



The Antisocial
Network



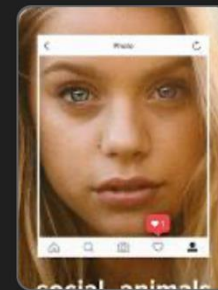
Like



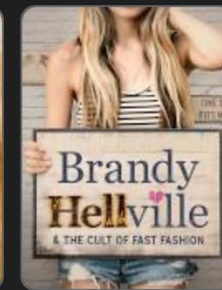
Catfish



Fyre



Social Animals



Brandy Hellville si



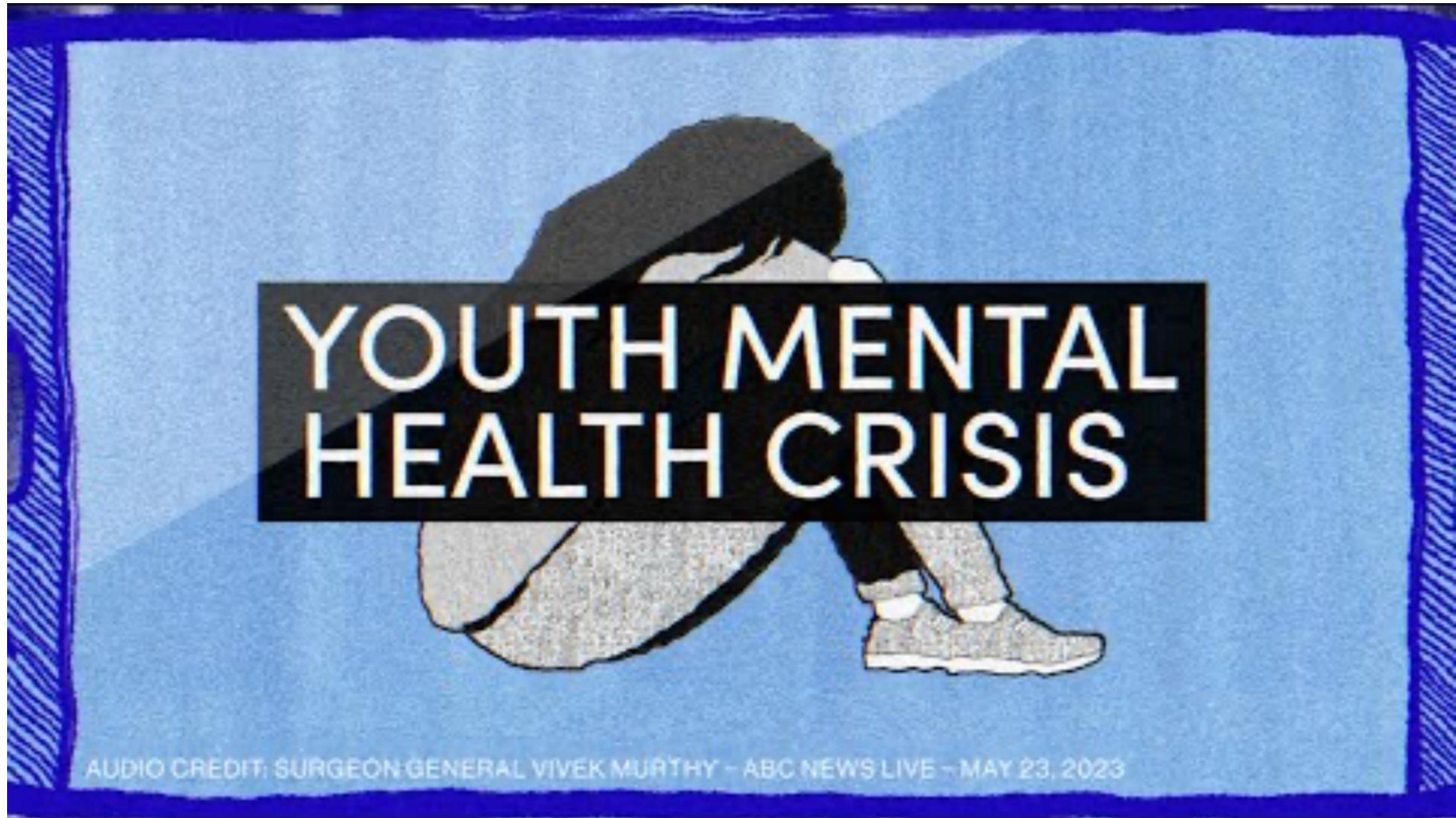
Rise of OnlyFans

CBS News- Is social media dying? (2.09. 2023)



- <https://youtu.be/cAL84EIZJsM?si=EC-7--DgwZbkWFm7>

ABC News: Does social media negatively impact teen mental health? (9.09.2023)



<https://youtu.be/gnEpRDh4Y2A?si=7rhzqrAmorQK8mpr>

Digital Nation (2010); Screenagers (2023)

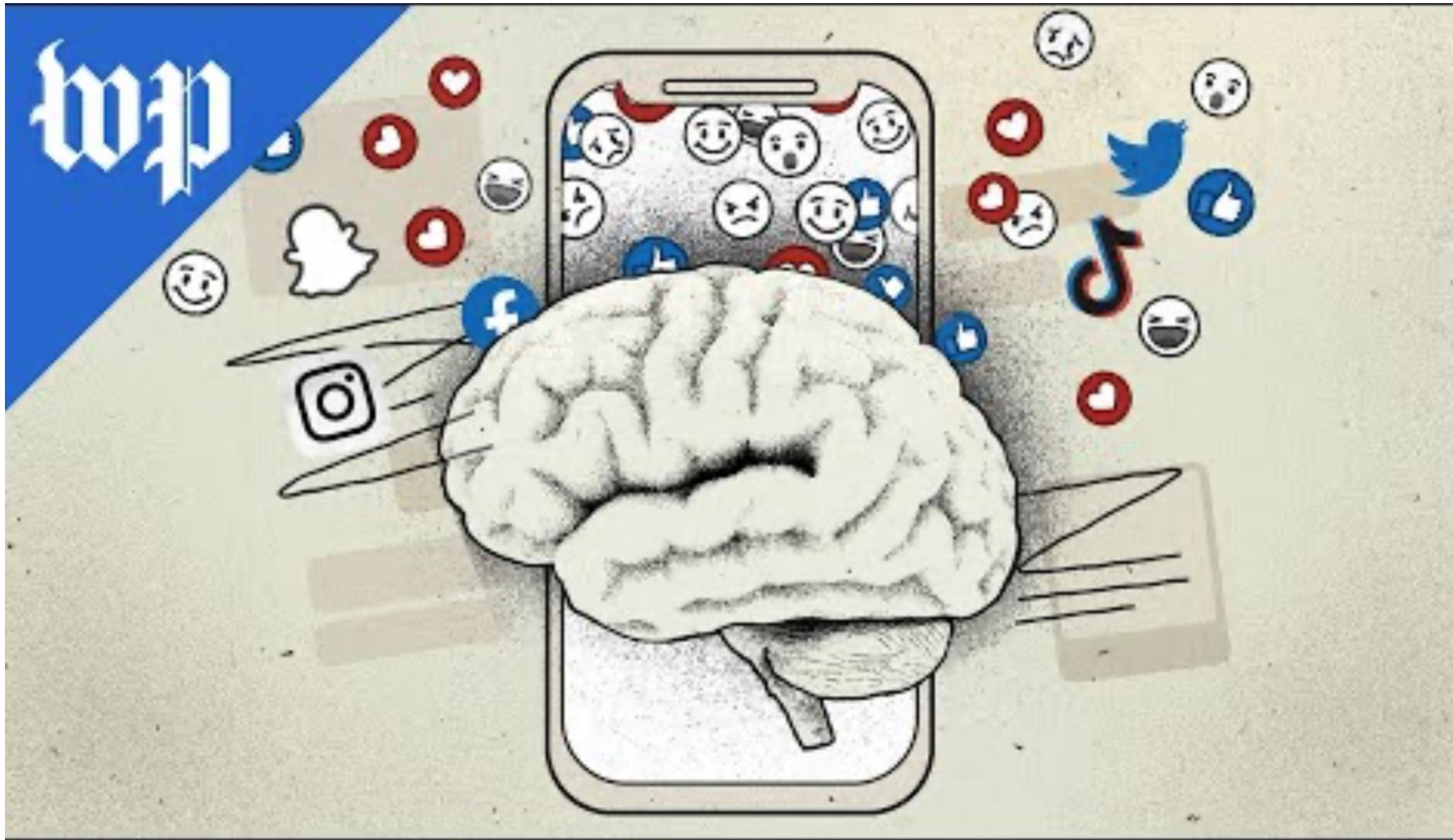


- <https://www.pbs.org/wgbh/frontline/film/digitalnation/>
- https://youtu.be/s9Kp6s_PK3k?si=guKLBIB1ueg53Wuq
- <https://www.screenagersmovie.com>

Teens, Social Media, and Technology (full documentary) | FRONTLINE (2019)



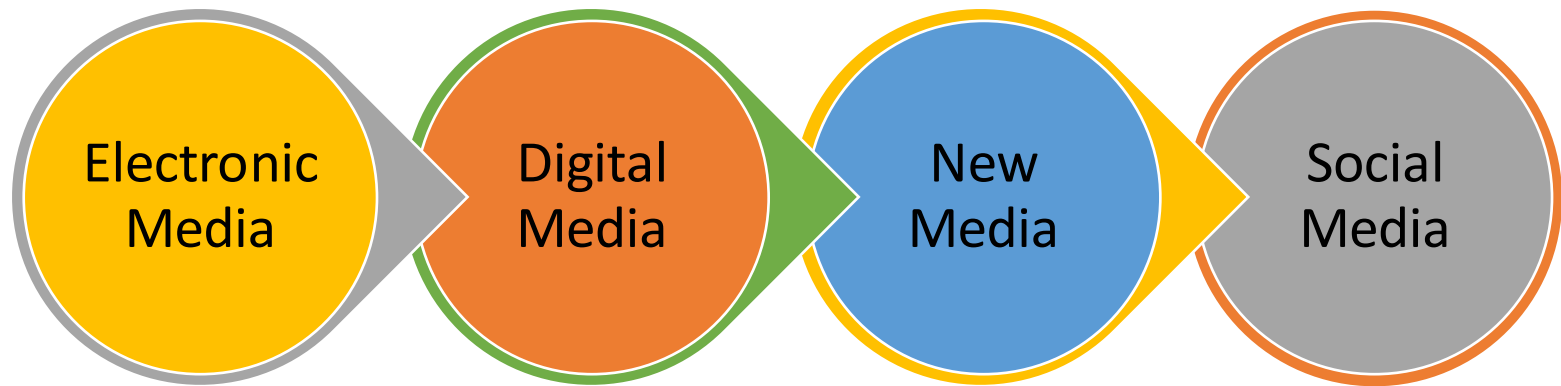
<https://youtu.be/JqamKb7gTWY?si=b5w7l0TVulzNGsMg>

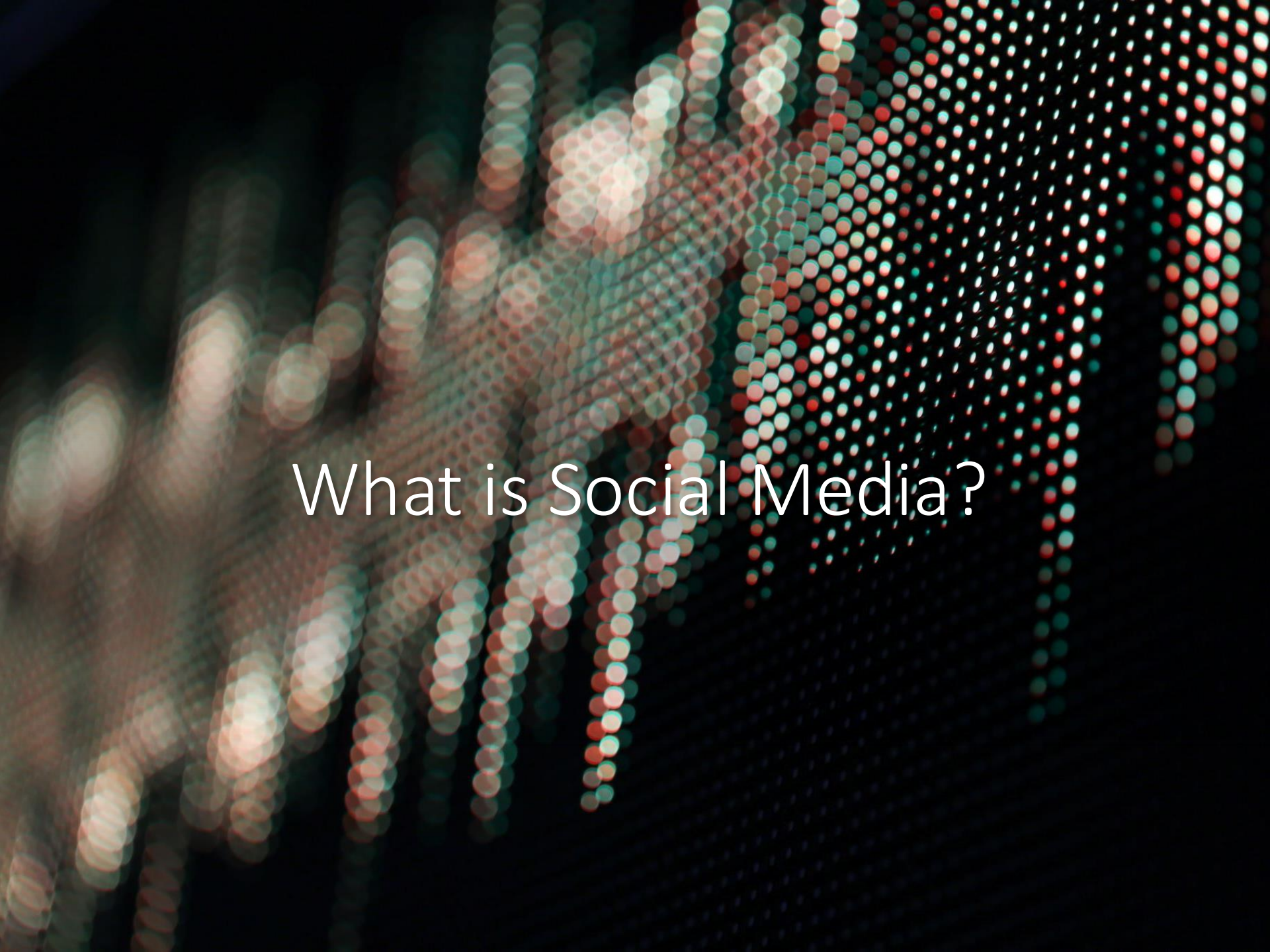


<https://youtu.be/rooEBjZWpDc?si=y5VcAwsb3xDpAsi6>

<https://youtu.be/bN4MNdCAnWA?si=7FMDDRvmAowczpW->





The background is a dark, abstract composition. It features a dense grid of small, circular bokeh lights in shades of red, orange, and teal. These lights are arranged in a way that creates a sense of depth and movement, with some areas appearing more focused than others. The overall effect is a vibrant, digital-looking pattern that fills the frame.

What is Social Media?

SOCIAL



Lat. **sociālis**

DEX '09: (adj) Created by society, belonging to society; relating to the life of people in society, their relations in society or to society; relating to human society

Cambridge Dictionary: (adj)

(1) relating to society and living together in an organized way / (2) relating to activities in which you meet and spend time with other people and that happen during the time when you are not working:



MEDIA



Lat. **media** (sg. *medium*)

conceptual and linguistic ambiguity

Coman (2007, p. 23):

„<<**media**>> is either the medium, or the technique, or the sum of the institutions, or all of them in one place, through which messages are circulated, in an increasingly rapid way, over ever larger geographical areas, to ever larger conglomerates of people".

What is social?

Actions, facts, togetherness - cohabitation, interdependence

- Social Action - Max Weber, Talcott Parsons
 - Action is social if it takes into account and is oriented towards the behaviour of others (symbolic-reciprocal interaction)
- Social fact - Émile Durkheim
 - *"a category of facts which have very special characteristics: they consist of ways of acting, thinking and feeling, external to the individual and endowed with a power of constraint by virtue of which they are imposed upon him." (2002, p.37)*

- Isn't the media (mass media) in its entirety social?

- MASS- MEDIA -->NEW MEDIA -> SOCIAL MEDIA

Institutions through which mass communication takes place - traditional channels

New technologies
enabling mass
communication via the
Internet

Participatory culture -
you can be both a
source of information
and audience

Van Dijck, 2013- *The culture of connectivity: A critical history of social media*

- „The very word ‘social’ associated with media implies that platforms are user centered and that they facilitate communal activities, just as the term ‘participatory’ emphasizes human collaboration. Indeed, social media can be seen as online facilitators or enhancers of *human* networks – webs of people that promote connectedness as a social value” (p, 11).
- „As a result of the interconnection of platforms, a new infrastructure emerged: an ecosystem of connective media with a few large and many small players. The transformation from networked communication to ‘platformed’ sociality, and from a participatory culture to a culture of connectivity”(p. 4).